

Free Tools & Communities List

A curated list of free resources to keep learning beyond the Academy.

Practice Platforms

- TryHackMe — beginner-friendly guided security labs
- HackTheBox — hands-on penetration testing challenges
- OWASP Juice Shop — practice web app vulnerabilities safely
- OverTheWire — classic Linux and security wargames

Free Learning Resources

- Cybrary — free introductory security courses
- Professor Messer — free Security+ exam prep videos
- Python.org official tutorial — free Python fundamentals
- Cloud provider free tiers (AWS, Azure, GCP) — hands-on cloud practice

Communities

- FutureStack Intelligence Academy WhatsApp Community
- r/cybersecurity and r/netsec on Reddit
- Local DEF CON groups (search for one in your city)
- Bug bounty platforms' community forums (HackerOne, Bugcrowd)

Tools Worth Installing

- Kali Linux — penetration testing distribution
- Wireshark — network traffic analysis
- Burp Suite Community Edition — web app testing
- VS Code — general-purpose code editor
- GitHub Desktop — version control made simple